



B K RAMESH

Reddy Brothers BELLARY BULLIES

In 2008, Janardhan, Karunakara, and Somashekhara Reddy—popularly known as the Bellary Brothers—helped the BJP to reach the magic figure of 113 in the 224-member Karnataka Assembly. But the lords of the mines also brought the Government to the brink in November when they claimed to have 60-odd MLAs on their side. In December, the CBI raided the head office of their Obulapuram Mining Company in Bellary and seized several documents. The Supreme Court's Commission for Environmental Cooperation has also said that their mining operations are illegal.

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P.D. Dinakaran NO, MY LORD

Justice Paul Daniel Dinakaran's elevation to the Supreme Court was put on hold following allegations that he had amassed assets disproportionate to his regular source of income. The Karnataka High Court chief justice is facing impeachment after 75 MPs in Rajya Sabha moved a motion on December 14. Dinakaran, a Dalit Christian, has found a supporter in Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Mayawati who claimed that the impeachment move was an attempt to victimise a Dalit.

Raj Thackeray GOONDA RAJ

He took *goondagiri* to newer heights, a legacy he inherited from his uncle and Shiv Sena supremo Bal Thackeray. Raj Thackeray, and his MNS goons spread mayhem in Mumbai by thrashing north Indian migrants. When he objected to Mumbai being referred as Bombay in the film *Wake Up Sid*, Karan Johar apologised publicly. The muscle flexing entered the Assembly when MNS MLAs roughed up Samajwadi Party MLA Abu Asim Azmi for taking the oath in Hindi instead of Marathi.

Pramod Muthalik INDECENT PROPOSALS

On January 24, a group of hooligans who called themselves Sri Ram Sene (SRS) activists barged into a pub in Mangalore and thrashed weekend revellers, including girls, accusing them of violating Indian culture. The group's chief Pramod Muthalik then vowed to target couples in public places on Valentine's Day. "SRS is a threat to India," said Home Minister P. Chidambaram. In December, SRS started its Beti Bachao Andolan to create awareness about the perils of 'love jihad' among women. The SRS is not against women falling in love, but they should be careful, says Muthalik.



PTI

NAVEEN JORA



BCCI and DDCA FLANNELLED FOOLS

More than a month before an unplayable pitch forced abandonment of the ODI between India and Sri Lanka on December 27, an ICC report had warned the BCCI that the pitch required "considerable improvement" before hosting its next fixture. But as usual, the Indian cricket board and its Delhi wing DDCA were more interested in the business of cricket than getting the basics of the game right.



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